



Nick of time: Ronald Araujo (left) turned hero for Barcelona with a 90+3-minute winner after being set up by Frenkie De Jong. AFP

fortunes and on-field performance in the recent past.

Bryan Mbeumo silenced Anfield in the second minute after latching onto a pass from Amad Diallo and expertly finding the net with a sublime finish. The early setback, however, did not deter Liverpool, and as expected, it continued to have a better attacking output against United.

Cody Gakpo, who was unlucky in the match, hitting the post three times, finally broke through the Red Devils' backline to grab an equaliser in the 78th minute. At that point, Liverpool, given its penchant for scoring late winners, was favourite to steal another victory from its arch-rival. But in the biggest of

surprises, it was United that took the lead again in the 84th minute. The match-winner? Harry Maguire. Getting on the end of an excellent cross by Bruno Fernandes, he towered over everyone to guide the ball home and pocket three points for his team.

The rest of the matches in matchday 8 of English top-flight football did not throw up many surprises. Barring Tottenham Hotspur's 1-2 loss against Aston Villa, all the traditional big teams enjoyed positive results.

Manchester City rode on an Erling Haaland brace to beat Everton 2-0. Arsenal beat Fulham courtesy of Leandro Trossard's goal, while Chelsea thrashed Nottingham Forest 3-0, a result that led to the sacking of Ange Postecoglou just 39 days after he was appointed manager of Forest.

The Crystal Palace vs Bournemouth clash was the

highest-scoring match of the weekend, with the teams playing out a 3-3 draw. Arsenal currently tops the table with 19 points. Man City (16), Bournemouth (15), and Liverpool (15) follow in second, third, and fourth, respectively. Chelsea (14) and Tottenham (14) are fifth and sixth, while United is ninth (13).

La Liga

It almost turned into a frustrating gameweek for Barcelona, with the Catalans almost settling for a 1-1 draw with Girona, but Ronald Araujo turned hero with a 90+3-minute winner after being set up by Frenkie De Jong. The match, however, did not just have drama on the pitch. Off it, too, it had its fair share of moments. Players of both teams stood still for 15 seconds after kick-off, which was a coordinated protest against the league's decision to stage a regular-season game in the United States.